Chapter 1. Introduction

Experiment, Design, and Statistics

1 Experiment, Design, and Statistics

- In any experiment, the experimenter is attempting to **draw certain inferences** or **make a decision** about some hypothesis.
- Decision-making needs **collecting data**.
- *Example (umbrella).* To decide whether or not to carry an umbrella on a given morning, one collects certain data: checking the barometer, looking at the sky, reading the newspaper forecast, listening to the radio, and so on. After quickly assimilating all the available data, a decision is made.
- **Statistics** is the science of making decisions (problem-solving) in the presence of variability (uncertainty).
- Decision-making based on statistical tools always involves the collection of data, so **how the data are collected** becomes extremely important.
- **Experimental designs** are used to help reduce the experimental error in data collection.
- **Randomization** is used to average out the effects of many (uncontrolled) variables in an experiment.

Definition 1.1: Basic principles of experimental design

(i) **Randomization.** Both the allocation of experimental material and the order in which the individual runs are performed are randomly determined. Statistical methods require that the observations (errors) be independently distributed random variables; randomization usually makes this assumption valid and "averages out" the effects of extraneous (lurking) factors.

(ii) **Replication.** An independent repeat run of each factor combination. Replication (a) allows estimation of the experimental error σ^2, which is the basic unit of measurement for deciding whether observed differences are real, and (b) gives a more precise estimate of a mean: if σ^2 is the variance of one observation, the sample mean of n replicates has variance σ^2/n.

(iii) **Blocking.** A technique to improve precision of comparisons among the factors of interest by reducing/eliminating the variability transmitted from nuisance factors. A block is a set of relatively homogeneous experimental conditions.

Remark 1.2: Why replication shrinks variance

If $y_1, \dots, y_n$ are independent with common variance σ^2, then

$$\begin{aligned}\operatorname{Var}(\bar{y}) &= \operatorname{Var}\Big(\frac{1}{n}\sum_{j=1}^{n} y_j\Big) = \frac{1}{n^2}\operatorname{Var}\Big(\sum_{j=1}^{n} y_j\Big) = \frac{1}{n^2}\sum_{j=1}^{n}\operatorname{Var}(y_j) \quad \text{(independence)} \\ &= \frac{1}{n^2}\cdot n\sigma^2 = \frac{\sigma^2}{n}.\end{aligned}$$

Hence, doubling the number of replicates halves the variance of a treatment mean. This simple fact is used repeatedly in every ANOVA derivation of later chapters (e.g. $\operatorname{Var}(\bar{\varepsilon}_{i\cdot}) = \sigma^2/n$).

2 Role of Statistics in Experimentation

- **Project planning phase**
  1. What is to be measured? (choice of the response variable)
  2. How large is the likely variation?
  3. What are the influential factors?
- **Experimental design phase**
  1. Control some known sources of variation (blocking).
  2. Allow estimation of the size of the uncontrolled variation (replication).
  3. Permit an investigation of suitable models.
- **Statistical analysis phase**
  1. Make inferences on design factors.
  2. Guide subsequent design.
  3. Suggest more appropriate models.

3 The General Workflow Used in This Course

Derivation

Every design studied in this course is analysed with the same three steps (illustrated with the two-sample model $y_{ij} = \mu_i + \varepsilon_{ij}$, $\varepsilon_{ij} \sim N(0, \sigma^2)$, i.e. $y_{ij} \sim N(\mu_i, \sigma^2)$, $H_0 : \mu_1 = \mu_2$):

① **Estimation**: fit the model, $y_{ij} = \hat{\mu}_i + e_{ij}$ (fitted value + residual);

② **Inference**: test hypotheses / build confidence intervals on the parameters;

③ **Residual analysis**: check the model assumptions (normality, constant variance, independence) using the residuals e_{ij}.

Design	Model	Chapter
Two-sample / paired comparison	$y_{ij} = \mu_i + \varepsilon_{ij},\ \ y_{ij} = \mu_i + \beta_j + \varepsilon_{ij}$	2
Completely randomized design (CRD)	$y_{ij} = \mu + \tau_i + \varepsilon_{ij}$	3
RCBD / BIBD	$y_{ij} = \mu + \tau_i + \beta_j + \varepsilon_{ij}$	4
Latin / Graeco-Latin square	$y_{ijk} = \mu + \alpha_i + \tau_j + \beta_k + \varepsilon_{ijk}$	4
Factorial design	$y_{ijk} = \mu + \tau_i + \beta_j + (\tau\beta)_{ij} + \varepsilon_{ijk}$	5
2^k factorial, blocking & confounding	effects via contrasts	6, 7
Regression approach	$\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\beta} + \boldsymbol{\varepsilon}$	10
Random / mixed effects	$\tau_i \sim N(0, \sigma_\tau^2)$	13
Nested and split-plot	$y_{ijk} = \mu + \tau_i + \beta_{j(i)} + \varepsilon_{(ij)k}, \ldots$	14
Analysis of covariance	$y_{ij} = \mu + \tau_i + \beta(x_{ij} - \bar{x}_{\cdot\cdot}) + \varepsilon_{ij}$	15